Guitar Exercises - Section XIII, Level 93

Compound Expressive Phrasing and Long-Form Articulation Arcs

Double-Stop Bends • Harmonic Punctuation • Tonal Contrast • Feedback/Sustain Concepts • Phrase Architecture

Level 93 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. HARD STOP after Level 105.

Levels 91-92 trained individual expressive devices. Level 93 turns them into phrase architecture: one articulation prepares another, intensity rises and falls deliberately, and the technique never outranks the harmonic target.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Double-stop bend calibration and voice stability	144
B	Compound bend/vibrato phrase mechanics	128
C	Harmonic punctuation and register contrast	112
D	Pick-versus-finger tonal contrast	112
E	Controlled feedback concepts and sustain management	96
F	Articulation density and phrase-arc design	128
G	Question/answer articulation orchestration	128
H	Four eight-bar long-form expressive studies	192
I	Thirty-two-bar articulation-arc capstone	256
J	Recovery, reduction, and expression audit	64
	TOTAL	1360

Core rule: expression must have a beginning, development, climax, and release - not a constant maximum intensity.

Reference - Articulation Intensity Ladder

Level	Example	Function
1	clean picked note / rest	neutral reference
2	grace note / slide / narrow vibrato	light color
3	rake / pre-bend / wider vibrato	statement emphasis
4	double-stop bend / pinch harmonic	climax color
5	compound chain	reserved for structural peak

A phrase should normally move between levels. Staying at level 4-5 for every bar destroys contrast.

Module A - Double-Stop Bend Calibration

One voice bends while the second acts as a pitch reference. First practice the stationary note alone, then the moving note, then combine them.

Cell	Fixed voice	Moving voice	Target
1	high tonic	lower note bends half step	minor-3rd color
2	high tonic	lower note bends whole step	unison or chord-tone match
3	high fifth	lower fourth bends to fifth	resolution
4	high third	lower second bends to third	major-color arrival
5	lower root	upper note bends whole step	reverse hierarchy
6	high note fixed	lower note pre-bent then released	descending tension
7	both attacked	one bends after 1 beat	delayed split motion
8	one bends, one vibrates lightly	independent expressive motion	

The fixed note must remain stable. If it drifts, reduce fretting pressure and isolate the bending hand motion.

Module A - Double-Stop Bend Timing

Arrival	Action
Beat 1	pre-bend moving voice; attack both exactly on target
& of 1	attack dyad, bend moving voice to target
Beat 2	slow whole-step arrival
Beat 3	hold dyad 2 beats, then bend
Beat 4	late expressive bend
& of 4	bend becomes pickup into next chord

Pass 2 adds vibrato only after both voices are centered.

Module B - Compound Bend/Vibrato Phrase Mechanics

Chain	Sequence	Control point
1	bend -> hold -> delayed vibrato	target centers before vibrato
2	pre-bend -> release -> vibrato	release ends on exact source
3	rake -> bend -> vibrato	rake stays below target dynamic
4	slide -> bend -> release	each pitch destination audible
5	bend -> partial release -> re-bend	same upper target twice
6	double-stop bend -> single-note vibrato	voice hierarchy changes
7	pinch harmonic -> bend -> vibrato	harmonic survives bend
8	bend -> rest -> soft answer	climax followed by space

Play every chain at half tempo first. If one stage becomes unclear, remove the previous articulation rather than adding more force.

Module C - Harmonic Punctuation and Register Contrast

Cell	Low/mid statement	High punctuation
1	Am7 chord-tone phrase	12th-fret natural harmonic
2	A7 blues phrase	pinch harmonic on 5th
3	Cmaj7 melody	high natural harmonic answer
4	E5 riff	pinch harmonic at bar ending
5	Dm7 phrase	harmonic before G7 resolution
6	G major line	harmonic as section boundary

Harmonics should punctuate structural moments: cadences, answers, section boundaries, or climaxes. Avoid using them as random decoration.

Module C - Register Lift and Drop

Pass	Bars 1-2	Bars 3-4
1	middle-register phrase	same motif one octave higher
2	low double-stops	high single-note answer
3	middle chord tone	high harmonic punctuation
4	high phrase	drop to low sustained resolution
5	wide register climax	return to one middle note
6	high sustained note	silence then low answer

Register change is part of expression. Do not increase note density automatically when moving higher.

Module D - Pick-versus-Finger Tonal Contrast

Pass	Attack	Goal
1	flat pick	clear reference
2	bare finger	rounder transient
3	pick near bridge	bright attack
4	finger near neck	soft attack
5	pick question / finger answer	timbral conversation
6	finger question / pick answer	reverse conversation
7	hybrid: pick bass + finger melody	two simultaneous colors
8	same volume, different attack source	tone not loudness

Use the same four-note motif. Keep pitch, rhythm, and volume as constant as possible so the tonal difference is the only variable.

Module E - Controlled Feedback and Sustain Concepts

These are volume-aware listening exercises, not a requirement to use unsafe stage volume. Use a controllable amp/modeler setup and hearing-safe levels.

Cell	Task	Goal
1	sustain one fretted note	hear natural decay
2	add mild gain/compression	extend sustain without extra picking
3	move guitar relative to speaker/modeler monitor	observe resonance changes
4	sustain note, add controlled vibrato	maintain pitch center
5	harmonic punctuation into sustain	transition texture
6	feedback/sustain note -> volume reduction	controlled exit
7	sustain across chord change	decide whether note remains consonant
8	replace feedback with volume swell if unavailable	preserve musical function

Stop if the environment becomes uncomfortably loud or unstable. The musical skill is sustain management, not sheer volume.

Module F - Articulation Density Ladder

Pass	Maximum ornaments per bar	Requirement
1	0	targets and rests only
2	1	one simple articulation
3	2	two compatible articulations
4	3	reserved for one climax bar
5	1	return immediately to restraint
6	0	end with plain tone or silence

Use an eight-bar phrase. Bars 1-2 establish, 3-4 develop, 5-6 peak, 7-8 release.

Module F - Long-Form Expression Arc

Bars	Intensity	Suggested devices
1-2	1-2	clean notes, slides, narrow vibrato
3-4	2-3	rake, pre-bend, double-stop slide
5	4	double-stop bend or pinch harmonic
6	3	bend + delayed vibrato
7	2	soft finger attack or swell
8	1	plain sustained target or rest

Repeat the arc over major, minor, and dominant progressions without changing the intensity shape.

Module G - Question/Answer Articulation Orchestration

Question	Answer
clean pick + narrow vibrato	rake -> bend
slide into target	finger-picked soft answer
double-stop slide	single-note pre-bend release
natural harmonic	low-register chord-tone response
pinch harmonic accent	rest + soft resolution
wide bend	plain note with no ornament
volume swell	short picked answer
muted pickup	open sustained target

The answer should contrast the question while remaining rhythmically related.

Module H - Study 1 - Blues expressive arc

| A7 | D7 | A7 | E7 | D7 | A7 | E7 | A7 |

Bars 1-2 restraint; 3-4 double-stop movement; bar 5 bend climax; 6-8 release.

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	intensity levels 1-2 only
3	full written arc
4	alternate articulation choices, same arc
5	record clean/light gain
6	reduce ornaments by 50% without losing shape

Module H - Study 2 - Minor vocal arc

| Am7 | Dm7 | E7 | Am7 | Fmaj7 | E7 | Am7 | Am7 |

Use pre-bends, delayed vibrato, finger-picked answers, and one pinch-harmonic climax.

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	intensity levels 1-2 only
3	full written arc
4	alternate articulation choices, same arc
5	record clean/light gain
6	reduce ornaments by 50% without losing shape

Module H - Study 3 - Major lyrical arc

| Cmaj7 | Am7 | Dm7 | G7 | Em7 | A7 | Dm7 | G7 |

Natural-harmonic punctuation and register lift without increasing density.

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	intensity levels 1-2 only
3	full written arc
4	alternate articulation choices, same arc
5	record clean/light gain
6	reduce ornaments by 50% without losing shape

Module H - Study 4 - Rock sustain arc

| E5 | G5 | A5 | E5 | D5 | A5 | E5 | E5 |

Pick/finger contrast, sustained climax, then reduced outro.

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	intensity levels 1-2 only
3	full written arc
4	alternate articulation choices, same arc
5	record clean/light gain
6	reduce ornaments by 50% without losing shape

Module I - Thirty-Two-Bar Articulation-Arc Capstone

Bars	Harmony	Arc role	Devices	Dynamic
1-4	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7	restraint	slides + narrow vibrato	p-mp
5-8	A7-D7-A7-E7	development	double-stop slides/bends	mf
9-12	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	color	harmonic punctuation	mp
13-16	E5-G5-A5-E5	first climax	pinch harmonic + sustain	f
17-20	Am7-E7-Am7-Am7	release/rebuild	finger tone + pre-bend	mp-mf
21-24	A7-D7-E7-A7	second climax	compound bend/vibrato	f
25-28	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	decompression	swell + clean answer	mf-mp
29-32	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7	outro	plain target, slow vibrato, rest	mp-pp

The capstone has two peaks, not thirty-two. Do not let every bar compete for attention.

Module J - Recovery, Reduction, and Expression Audit

Failure	Immediate repair
Double-stop bend destabilizes fixed note	isolate fixed voice, then moving voice
Compound chain becomes messy	remove first ornament
Pinch harmonic misses	play normal target and continue
Sustain/feedback becomes unstable	reduce gain/volume; use plain sustain
Pick/finger balance changes volume	normalize dynamics before tone contrast
Expression arc peaks too early	cap ornaments at level 2 until planned climax
Every phrase sounds decorated	perform one entire bar with no ornament
Form lost	targets and rests only until next section

Mastery: 14/16 or better on two separate days across double-stop bend stability, compound articulation clarity, harmonic punctuation, tonal contrast, sustain control, phrase-arc shape, restraint, and recovery. No zero in pitch control, phrase-arc shape, restraint, or recovery.

Next: Level 94 completes Section XIII with expressive-performance synthesis: articulation selection under changing harmony, emotional contour, dynamic/tonal orchestration, restraint, and a complete expressive solo capstone.

Fixed roadmap: 91-94 Advanced Expression; 95-99 Repertoire Integration; 100-104 Composition; 105 Final Musicianship Capstone. HARD STOP after 105.